

CHAPTER 1

The Hidden Language of AI

Most people talk to AI like they are sending a quick text to a friend. Short, vague, hoping the other side figures it out. And then they wonder why the response is generic, shallow, or completely off target.

The Prompt Engineering Playbook

Here is the truth most power users will not tell you: the quality of your AI output is almost entirely determined by the quality of your input. The same AI that gives a mediocre answer to a lazy prompt can produce something remarkably close to brilliance when given the right instructions.

Consider these two prompts:

⚠ NOTE

"Write me something about productivity"

💡 PRO TIP

"You are a productivity coach writing for college students. Create a 500-word guide titled 5 Morning Habits That Double Your Focus. Use a friendly, motivational tone. Include one real study (with citation format), three actionable tips with specific examples, and a closing challenge. Format with subheadings and bullet points."

Both prompts ask about productivity. The first will give you a forgettable paragraph. The second will give you something you could actually publish. The difference is not the AI — it is the prompt.

This book is about mastering that difference. By the time you finish, you will have a systematic framework for crafting prompts that consistently produce exactly what you need — whether you are writing essays, debugging code, preparing for exams, building a resume, or creating content.

*"The art and science of asking questions is the source of all knowledge."
— Thomas Berger"*

Why Prompt Engineering Is the Skill of the Decade

Prompt engineering is not just a technical trick. It is arguably the most important new skill of the AI era. Here is why:

1. It multiplies every other skill. A writer who masters prompts writes faster. A coder who masters prompts ships more. A student who masters prompts learns deeper. Prompting is a force multiplier applied on top of everything else you do.

2. It is the bridge between human intent and machine capability. AI models are extraordinarily powerful, but they cannot read your mind. Prompt engineering is the translation layer — it converts what you want into instructions the machine can execute precisely.

3. It is the one skill that works across all AI tools. Whether you use ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, Perplexity, or any future model — the principles of good prompting transfer. You are not learning a specific tool. You are learning how to communicate with intelligence itself.

""AI will not replace humans. But humans who master AI will replace humans who do not.""

Who This Book Is For

Students who want to study smarter, write better papers, and prepare for exams more efficiently.

Professionals who use AI at work and need consistent, reliable results — not random outputs.

Content creators who want to use AI as a creative partner without losing their voice.

Curious beginners who are tired of getting generic answers and want to unlock what AI can really do.

Developers who want to write better technical prompts for code generation and documentation.

Whatever your background, if you interact with AI tools — and in 2026, that is nearly everyone — this book will make those interactions dramatically more productive.

How to Use This Book

This is not a book you read once and put on a shelf. It is a working manual. Here is the best way to get value from it:

1. Read through the C.O.R.E. framework (Chapters 2–5) and practice each component. Do not skip the exercises.

2. Apply the techniques immediately. After each chapter, pick a real task and use what you just learned. Theory without practice is just trivia.
3. Build your prompt library. As you find prompts that work, save them. The Master Prompt Library in Chapter 8 gives you a head start.
4. Revisit the advanced chapters (6–7) once you have the basics down. They build on each other.
5. Teach someone else. Nothing cements knowledge like teaching. Share a prompt trick with a friend. Write about it. Explain it out loud.

CHAPTER 2



The C.O.R.E. Framework

Every great prompt can be broken down into four essential elements. I call this the C.O.R.E. framework, and it is the single tool that will transform your AI interactions more than anything else in this book.

C.O.R.E. stands for:

Letter	Element	Purpose
C	Context	Set the scene and background
O	Objective	Define exactly what you want
R	Response Format	Specify the output structure
E	Examples	Show what good looks like

Let me show you the difference this makes. Here is a weak prompt:

WEAK PROMPT

Help me with my resume.

And here is the same request using C.O.R.E.:

C.O.R.E. PROMPT

Context: I am a third-year Computer Science student applying for a summer internship at Google. I have completed two personal projects (a weather app and a chatbot) and have a 3.7 GPA.

Objective: Improve the "Experience" section of my resume to better highlight my technical skills and project work for a software engineering internship.

Response Format: Provide 3 revised bullet points for each position/project. Use strong action verbs and include measurable outcomes where possible.

Examples:

Weak: "Built a weather app using React"

Strong: "Developed a React-based weather application serving 200+ daily users, reducing API response time by 40% through intelligent caching"

C Is for Context

Context is the background information your AI needs to give you a relevant answer. Without context, the AI has to guess — and it often guesses wrong.

Think of it this way: if you asked a tutor to help you with your homework, you would not just shove the problem at them without saying what class it is, what topics you have covered, and where you are stuck. Context is giving your AI tutor that same information.

Effective context includes:

- Your role or situation: "I am a college student studying..."
- The background: "We are working on a project about..."
- What you have already tried: "I have already attempted X and Y, but Z is not working..."
- Constraints: "I have 2 hours and can only use free tools..."
- The audience: "This is for a professor who values data-driven arguments..."

❏ PRO TIP

Pro Tip: You do not need to write novels for context. Two to five well-chosen sentences are usually more effective than a wall of text. Specificity beats length every time.

O Is for Objective

The objective is the single most important part of your prompt. It is where you define what success looks like. A vague objective produces a vague answer. A precise objective gets you exactly what you need.

Vague Objective	Precise Objective
Tell me about climate change	Explain the three most significant causes of climate change for a high-school audience, using one real-world example for each
Help me write a blog post	Write a 1,200-word blog post titled "5 AI Tools That Will Change How Students Study in 2026"
Make this better	Rewrite this paragraph to be more persuasive for a business audience. Keep the core message. Add a compelling statistic.

Test your objective with this question: "If the AI returned exactly this, would I be satisfied?" If the answer is "maybe," your objective needs more specificity.

R Is for Response Format

AI can produce almost any format you ask for: paragraphs, bullet points, tables, code, step-by-step instructions, prose, poetry, JSON, and more. If you do not specify, it defaults to paragraphs — which is rarely what you actually want.

Common format instructions that dramatically improve outputs:

- "Present as a comparison table..."
- "Give me 5 bullet points, each under 20 words..."
- "Write this as a step-by-step tutorial with numbered steps..."
- "Output as a JSON object with the following keys..."
- "Use the structure: Problem → Cause → Solution → Example..."
- "Write in a conversational tone, as if explaining to a friend..."

❏ PRO TIP

The format instruction comes AFTER the objective in your prompt. Think of it as: "Do [OBJECTIVE] and present it as [FORMAT]."

E Is for Examples

Examples are the secret weapon of advanced prompt engineering. When you show the AI what good output looks like — even with a single example — the quality jumps dramatically. This technique is called "few-shot prompting" and it is used by professional AI engineers every day.

Example of few-shot prompting:

FEW-SHOT PROMPT

Convert these course titles into SEO-friendly blog post titles.

Examples:

Course: "Introduction to Python" → "Python for Absolute Beginners: Your First Line of Code in 30 Minutes"

Course: "Data Visualization" → "Turn Boring Data into Beautiful Charts: A Student's Guide to Data Viz"

Now convert:

1. "Machine Learning Basics"
2. "Web Development Fundamentals"
3. "Cloud Computing Overview"

Notice how the AI can now see the pattern: academic titles are transformed into benefit-driven, specific blog titles. One or two examples give the AI a template to follow.

CHAPTER 3

Context Engineering

Context engineering goes beyond the basic C.O.R.E. framework. It is the practice of building rich, layered context that transforms AI from a search engine replacement into a genuine thinking partner.

The core idea is simple: the more relevant background you provide, the more useful the response. But the art is in knowing what context matters and how to structure it for maximum impact.

The Context Window: Your Working Memory

Every AI model has a "context window" — the maximum amount of text it can consider at once. Think of this as the AI working memory. Whatever fits inside the window can influence the response. Whatever falls outside is invisible.

Model	Approximate Context Window
Claude 3.5 Sonnet	200,000 tokens (~150,000 words)
GPT-4o	128,000 tokens (~100,000 words)
Gemini 2.0	1,000,000+ tokens

Model	Approximate Context Window
Llama 3 (local)	8,000 – 128,000 tokens

This means you can feed entire documents, codebases, or research papers into some models and ask questions about them. But even with smaller context windows, strategic context placement makes a huge difference.

The Three Layers of Context

Layer 1: Role Context. Who should the AI be for this conversation? "You are a senior software engineer," "You are a strict but fair professor," "You are a creative director at an ad agency."

Layer 2: Task Context. What specific task are we working on? Provide the background, the constraints, where you are in the process, and what has already been decided.

Layer 3: Output Context. What should the final output look like? Length, tone, format, audience, purpose. The more specifically you define the target, the closer the AI hits it.

THREE-LAYER CONTEXT

Layer 1 (Role): You are an academic writing tutor helping undergraduate students.

Layer 2 (Task): I am writing a 2,000-word essay on the impact of social media on mental health for my Psychology 101 course. My thesis is that social media use correlates with increased anxiety in teens, but the relationship is not as simple as "social media is bad." I have found three peer-reviewed studies. The essay is due Friday.

Layer 3 (Output): Help me outline the essay. The outline should have: an introduction with a hook, three body sections (one per study), a counterargument section, and a conclusion. For each section, provide a 1-sentence summary and suggest a potential source or example.

The Pre-Prompt Technique

Advanced prompt engineers often set up a conversation with a "pre-prompt" before the real work begins. This pre-prompt establishes the AI behavior, tone, and rules for the entire conversation.

PRE-PROMPT

Before we begin, here are the rules for this conversation:

1. Always ask clarifying questions if my request is ambiguous
2. When giving technical explanations, assume I am a motivated beginner
3. Always provide reasoning behind your suggestions, not just answers
4. If something could be done in multiple ways, present 2-3 options with trade-offs
5. Flag any claims that might need fact-checking

Are you ready?

This technique is especially powerful for long, multi-turn conversations where you want consistency throughout.

CHAPTER 4

Role-Playing and Persona Prompts

One of the most powerful prompt techniques is giving the AI a specific role or persona. This is not just a gimmick — it fundamentally changes the quality, tone, and depth of responses by activating different patterns in the model knowledge.

When you say "You are a NASA engineer," the AI shifts into a mode that prioritizes precision, technical accuracy, and systematic thinking. When you say "You are a storytelling coach," it becomes more narrative-focused, emotionally attuned, and example-driven.

How to Craft Effective Personas

The best personas have three elements:

1. Expertise domain: What does this person know? "a data scientist with 10 years of experience in NLP"
2. Communication style: How do they explain things? "using simple analogies and avoiding jargon"
3. Values/priorities: What matters to them? "produces reproducible results and always cites sources"

PERSONA PROMPT EXAMPLE

You are a debate coach who has trained national-level college debaters for 15 years. You are known for helping students strengthen their weakest arguments.

I am preparing for a debate on: "AI will do more harm than good for education."

I am arguing FOR the proposition. My main points are:

1. AI enables academic dishonesty at scale
2. Over-reliance reduces critical thinking skills
3. Widens the education gap between rich and schools

Help me prepare for cross-examination by:

1. Identifying the strongest counterarguments against each point
2. Suggesting rebuttals for each counterargument
3. Providing one compelling statistic or study for each of my points

Use Socratic questioning – make me defend my position rigorously.

The Anti-Persona Trick

Sometimes, the best way to find weaknesses is to ask the AI to argue against itself:

ANTI-PERSONA

Now switch roles. You are the opposition debater. Attack each of my three points with the strongest possible counterarguments. Be ruthless. I need to be prepared for the worst.

This "red team" approach dramatically improves the quality of your arguments, code, writing, or any output by pre-exposing weaknesses.

Persona Cheat Sheet for Common Tasks

Task	Best Persona
Debugging code	Senior engineer who specializes in finding edge cases
Writing a resume	Hiring manager who screens 50 resumes per week
Reviewing an essay	Strict professor who values clear thesis + evidence
Brainstorming ideas	Creative director with no budget constraints
Learning a new topic	Patient tutor who loves teaching beginners
Negotiating/selling	Sales psychology expert

CHAPTER 5

Chain-of-Thought Techniques

Chain-of-thought (CoT) prompting is the single most impactful technique for getting AI to solve complex problems correctly. The concept is deceptively simple: instead of asking for an answer, ask the AI to think step by step.

Research has shown that simply adding "Let think step by step" to a prompt can dramatically improve performance on math, logic, and reasoning tasks. But there is much more to CoT than that magic phrase.

The Basic CoT Pattern

The simplest form:

BASIC COT

Solve this problem step by step, showing your reasoning at each stage.

For more complex problems, guide the thinking:

STRUCTURED CoT

Approach this problem systematically:

1. First, identify what we know and what we need to find
2. Break the problem into smaller sub-problems
3. Solve each sub-problem in order
4. Combine the results and verify the answer makes sense
5. State any assumptions you made

Problem: [your problem here]

When to Use Chain-of-Thought

Use CoT When	Skip CoT When
Multi-step math or logic	Simple factual questions
Debugging complex code	Looking up definitions
Planning or strategizing	Quick formatting requests
Comparing options	Simple rewrites
Code architecture decisions	Short creative bursts

Self-Consistency Prompting

An advanced CoT technique: ask the AI to solve the same problem multiple ways and then compare results. This catches errors and produces more reliable answers.

SELF-CONSISTENCY

Solve this problem using two completely different approaches. Then compare the results. If they match, the answer is likely correct. If they differ, identify where the discrepancy comes from and determine which approach is more reliable.

CHAPTER 6

Iterative Refinement Loops

The biggest mistake people make with AI is expecting perfection on the first try. The most effective AI users treat prompting as a conversation — a back-and-forth refinement process that progressively improves the output.

Think of it like editing a draft. The first response is a rough draft. Your follow-up prompts are the editing passes. Each iteration gets closer to what you actually need.

The Refinement Cycle

Follow this cycle for any important output:

1. Initial prompt: Use C.O.R.E. to get a solid first draft.
2. Evaluate: What is good? What is missing? What is wrong?
3. Targeted revision: Ask for specific changes. "Make the introduction more compelling." "Add a real-world example to point 3." "Shorten this by 30%."
4. Quality check: "Review this and flag any claims that might be inaccurate."
5. Final polish: "Adjust the tone to be more conversational." "Add a strong closing paragraph."

❏ PRO TIP

Each refinement prompt should change ONE thing at a time. If you ask for five changes at once, the AI will miss at least two of them. Be surgical.

Power Refinement Phrases

What You Want	Say This
Make it shorter	"Condense this to half the length while keeping the key points"
Make it longer	"Expand each point with a specific example and explanation"
Change the tone	"Rewrite this in a [professional/casual/urgent] tone"
Fix a section	"Rewrite paragraph 3. The argument is unclear. Use a concrete example."
Add depth	"Go deeper on point 2. Add data, a case study, or a counterargument."
Improve flow	"Reorganize this so each section leads naturally to the next"
Check accuracy	"Review this for factual errors. Flag anything uncertain."

The "Yes, And" Technique

Borrowed from improv comedy, this technique builds on what the AI gives you instead of starting over:

YES AND REFINEMENT

This is good. Now:

- Keep the structure of sections 1 and 3
- Rewrite section 2 to focus on [specific topic]
- Add a real case study after section 4
- End with a call to action that motivates the reader to start today

CHAPTER 7

Subject-Specific Prompt Systems

Different tasks require different prompt strategies. Here are battle-tested prompt systems for the most common student and professional use cases.

For Academic Writing

ACADEMIC WRITING PROMPT

You are an academic writing tutor. Help me with my [essay/research paper/assignment].

Topic: [your topic]

Thesis: [your thesis or main argument]

Length: [word count]

Citation style: [APA/MLA/Chicago]

Audience: [professor/peers/general public]

Task: [outline/draft introduction/review my argument/suggest sources]

Additional requirements: [any specific instructions]

For Coding and Debugging

DEBUGGING PROMPT

You are a senior [language] developer. Help me with this code.

What I am trying to do: [describe the goal]

Current code: [paste code]

The error or problem: [describe what is going wrong]

What I have already tried: [list attempts]

Please:

1. Identify the bug or issue
2. Explain why it is happening
3. Provide the corrected code
4. Suggest any improvements for readability or performance

For Exam Preparation

EXAM PREP PROMPT

You are a [subject] professor creating a practice exam.

Topic: [specific topic]

My current level: [beginner/intermediate/advanced]

Exam format: [multiple choice/short answer/essay]

Generate:

1. 5 practice questions of increasing difficulty
2. Detailed answers for each
3. Common mistakes students make on this topic
4. A one-page study checklist for this topic

For Career Documents

CAREER PROMPT

You are a career coach who has helped 500+ students land internships at top companies.

I am applying for: [role] at [company]

My background: [relevant experience, skills, education]

Job description key requirements: [paste or summarize]

Help me write:

1. A tailored resume summary (3 lines)
2. 3 bullet points for my most relevant experience
3. A cover letter opening paragraph that stands out
4. 3 questions I should ask in the interview

CHAPTER 8

The Master Prompt Library

This chapter gives you 20 ready-to-use prompts organized by category. Copy them, customize them, and make them your own. These are the prompts I use most often — refined over hundreds of hours of AI interaction.

Learning & Study Prompts

1. The Feynman Technique Prompt:

Explain [topic] as if I am a complete beginner. Use simple language, analogies, and examples. After your explanation, ask me three questions to test my understanding, and provide the answers separately.

2. The Study Plan Generator:

I need to learn [topic] in [timeframe]. My current level is [beginner/intermediate]. Create a day-by-day study plan with specific resources, practice exercises, and self-checks for each day.

3. The Concept Mapper:

Create a detailed concept map for [topic]. Show the main concept, 5-7 sub-concepts, and how they relate to each other. For each sub-concept, provide a one-sentence definition and a real-world example.

Writing & Content Prompts

4. The Blog Post Blueprint:

Write a blog post about [topic] for [audience]. Structure: hook, problem, 3 solutions with examples, counterargument, conclusion with CTA. Tone: [casual/professional]. Length: [words]. Include 5 SEO keywords: [list].

5. The Editor Prompt:

Review this text and provide specific feedback on: (1) clarity of the main argument, (2) strength of evidence, (3) logical flow, (4) grammar and style, (5) one thing to cut and one thing to expand. Then provide a revised version.

[Paste your text]

Productivity & Planning Prompts

6. The Weekly Review:

Here is what I accomplished this week: [list]. Here is what I planned but did not finish: [list]. Help me: (1) identify patterns in what slowed me down, (2) suggest 3 improvements for next week, (3) create a prioritized task list for Monday.

7. The Decision Matrix:

I am deciding between [option A] and [option B]. My priorities are: [list 3-5 factors]. Create a decision matrix scoring each option on each factor (1-10). Then give me your recommendation with reasoning.

Career & Professional Prompts

8. The LinkedIn Post Generator:

Write a LinkedIn post about [topic/experience]. Make it personal and authentic. Start with a hook that stops the scroll. Include a lesson learned. End with a question to encourage engagement. Keep it under 300 words.

9. The Interview Prepper:

I have an interview for [role] at [company]. The job description says: [paste]. Generate: (1) 10 likely interview questions, (2) strong answers for each using my background [describe], (3) 5 questions I should ask the interviewer.

10. The Networking Message:

Write a cold outreach message to [person type] on LinkedIn. Context: [why you are reaching out]. Keep it under 150 words. Make it specific, respectful of their time, and include a clear but low-pressure ask.

CHAPTER 9

Advanced Techniques & Pitfalls

You now have a solid foundation. This chapter covers advanced techniques that separate good prompts from great ones — and the common pitfalls that can undermine even well-crafted prompts.

Advanced Techniques

1. **Prompt Chaining.** Break complex tasks into a sequence of prompts, where each builds on the previous output. This is more effective than trying to do everything in one prompt.
2. **Negative Constraints.** Tell the AI what NOT to do. "Do not use jargon." "Do not give generic advice." "Do not include an introduction — jump straight to the analysis."
3. **Temperature Guidance.** For creative tasks, ask for "multiple different approaches." For analytical tasks, ask for "the single best answer with reasoning."
4. **Meta-Prompting.** Ask the AI to help you write better prompts: "I want to achieve [goal]. What information would you need from me to give the best possible response?"

5. Template Building. Once you find a prompt that works, turn it into a reusable template with [bracketed variables] you can fill in for different situations.

Common Pitfalls to Avoid

⚠ NOTE

Pitfall #1: The Kitchen Sink Prompt — cramming too many requests into one prompt. The AI will do a mediocre job on all of them instead of a great job on one. Break it up.

⚠ NOTE

Pitfall #2: Assuming the AI remembers. In a new conversation, the AI knows nothing about you. Always provide context, even if you talked about it yesterday.

⚠ NOTE

Pitfall #3: Accepting the first answer. The AI first response is its most generic. Push back, ask for alternatives, request improvements.

⚠ NOTE

Pitfall #4: Not fact-checking. AI can sound confident while being wrong. Always verify important claims, especially statistics and citations.

⚠ NOTE

Pitfall #5: Over-prompting. If a simple question gets a good answer, do not add complexity for the sake of it. Sometimes the best prompt is the simplest one.

Building Your Personal Prompt System

The ultimate goal is not to memorize prompts — it is to build a personal system. Here is how:

1. Create a prompt journal. Every time you get a great result, save the prompt. Note what worked and why.
2. Build templates for recurring tasks. You probably write similar emails, do similar research, or create similar content regularly. Template these.
3. Review and refine monthly. As AI models improve, some prompts become unnecessary and others become more powerful. Stay current.
4. Share and learn. Join communities of prompt engineers. Share your best prompts. Steal others (with attribution). The field moves fast.

CHAPTER 10



The Future of Prompting

AI is evolving at breathtaking speed. Models are getting more capable, multimodal, and autonomous. Does that mean prompt engineering will become obsolete? The opposite.

As AI becomes more powerful, the ability to direct that power becomes more valuable, not less. A more powerful tool in untrained hands is more dangerous and less useful than a simpler tool in skilled hands.

What Is Changing

Models are getting better at understanding intent. Future models will need less explicit instruction for simple tasks. But complex, high-stakes tasks will always benefit from precise prompting.

Multimodal prompting is emerging. Soon you will prompt with images, voice, video, and code simultaneously. The principles in this book — clarity, context, structure — will apply to all of them.

AI agents are the next frontier. Instead of prompting for a single response, you will design prompts that guide AI agents through multi-step workflows. The C.O.R.E. framework scales to this.

What Is Not Changing

The fundamental skill of clear communication with AI will remain valuable. The ability to:

- Define exactly what you want
- Provide relevant context
- Structure your requests logically
- Iterate and refine outputs
- Evaluate quality critically

These are not just AI skills. They are thinking skills. The discipline of crafting a precise prompt is the discipline of precise thinking. And that is valuable regardless of what AI looks like in five or fifty years.

"The best way to predict the future is to build it. Start building your prompt engineering skills today."

Thank you for reading The Prompt Engineering Playbook.

If this book helped you, share it with a friend who is still typing one-word prompts into ChatGPT. They will thank you.

— Joy Roy, Founder of Aryvora

WORKBOOK & EXERCISES

Put It Into Practice

Exercise 1: Build Your C.O.R.E. Template

Take a real task you need to complete this week. Write a C.O.R.E. prompt for it. Use all four elements: Context, Objective, Response Format, and Examples.

Your Turn

Write your C.O.R.E. prompt here: Context: Objective: Response Format: Examples: Now run it in your AI tool. Rate the output 1-10. What would you change?

Exercise 2: The Prompt Makeover Challenge

Find three prompts you have used recently (check your chat history). Rewrite each one using the C.O.R.E. framework. Compare the outputs.

Your Turn

Original prompt 1: Rewritten prompt 1: Difference in output: Original prompt 2: Rewritten prompt 2: Difference in output: Original prompt 3: Rewritten prompt 3: Difference in output:

Exercise 3: Create a Persona Library

Define 5 personas you would use regularly. For each, write the role, communication style, and values. Save these as templates.

Your Turn

Persona 1: Role: Style: Values: Persona 2: Role: Style: Values:
(Continue for all 5)

Exercise 4: Chain-of-Thought Practice

Pick a complex problem (math, logic, or planning). Solve it with and without chain-of-thought prompting. Compare the results.

Your Turn

Problem: Without CoT — Prompt used: Output quality (1-10): With CoT —
Prompt used: Output quality (1-10): What was different?

Exercise 5: Build Your Prompt Library

Create 10 prompts you will use regularly. Organize them by category. Save them in a document you can access quickly.

Your Turn

Category 1: _____ Prompt 1: Prompt 2: Prompt 3: Category 2:
_____ Prompt 1: Prompt 2: Prompt 3: Category 3: _____ Prompt 1:
Prompt 2: Prompt 3:

PROMPT LIBRARY



Ready-to-Use Prompts

The Explainer

Explain [topic] to me as if I am [audience level]. Use [number] real-world examples and avoid jargon. Structure: definition → why it matters → how it works → example → common misconception.

The Summarizer

Summarize the following text in [number] bullet points. Preserve all key facts and data. Use simple language.

[Paste text]

The Devil's Advocate

Here is my argument: [argument]. Now argue against it as effectively as possible. Find the weakest points. I need to stress-test this.

The Simplifier

I am struggling to understand [concept]. Explain it using an analogy from everyday life. Then explain it step by step. Then give me a one-sentence summary.

The Expander

Here is my rough idea: [idea]. Expand this into a detailed [outline/draft/plan]. Add examples, data, and counterarguments I might have missed.

The Reviewer

Review this [essay/code/plan] and give specific, actionable feedback. Rate it 1-10. List the top 3 strengths and top 3 areas for improvement. Then provide a revised version.

[Paste content]

The Interviewer

Act as a [role] interviewer. Ask me one question at a time. After each answer, provide brief feedback and ask the next question. Focus on [topic/area].

The Translator

Rewrite this [technical/boring/complex] text for a [target audience]. Make it [engaging/simple/professional] while keeping the core message.

[Paste text]

The Brainstorm Partner

I need ideas for [challenge]. Give me 10 creative approaches. For each, briefly explain why it might work and what could go wrong. Do not filter – include wild ideas.

The Decision Helper

I am deciding between [option A] and [option B]. My priorities are [list]. Analyze each option against each priority. Give me a recommendation with reasoning. Also tell me what information I might be missing.

QUICK REFERENCE

Cheat Sheet

- C.O.R.E. = Context + Objective + Response Format + Examples
- Always specify WHO the AI should be (persona/role)
- Always specify the FORMAT you want (bullets, table, paragraphs, code)
- Use examples to show what good output looks like
- For complex problems: "Think step by step"
- Refine iteratively — one change at a time
- Tell the AI what NOT to do (negative constraints)
- Break big tasks into prompt chains
- Save your best prompts as reusable templates
- Always fact-check important claims

Pro Tip

Print this page and keep it at your desk while you work.